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Halter Hiring Team

Halter

RE: PRODUCT SPECIALIST, U.S.

Dear Halter Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Product Specialist role because it sits exactly where I want my career to go: on the ground with the people using the product, translating what they need back into what gets built. **The image of 500 cattle standing up and walking calmly to their next break, no ATVs or fences involved, is the kind of quiet, well-engineered magic I want to spend my time explaining, protecting, and improving for ranchers.**

I don't come to this from inside a ranching operation, but I come to it with a real and long-standing pull toward land and agriculture. My Honors thesis used spatial statistics — kriging, IDW, local Moran's I — to study spatial patterns in organic and regenerative farming. I've done hands-on fieldwork on organic farms through WWOOF. And it's not academic for me: I think seriously about running my own ranch someday, which is part of why a company spending its engineering effort on making grazing better, for animals and the land and the people running it, is genuinely exciting to me rather than just an interesting problem.

The rest of my career has been spent doing the specific job this role describes, just in other domains. At Homebot and Lytics, I sat between engineering teams and the people actually using the product, turning field reality and customer feedback into product priorities. At the National Park Service, I built geospatial tools for park rangers and field staff who weren't GIS specialists — the same translation problem as making a virtual-fencing app make sense to a rancher who's never needed one before. At Teren, I worked with machine-learning models built from drone and satellite imagery to assess environmental conditions on land, which means I already think in the kind of geospatial and animal-movement data Halter's collars are generating. And right now, as a technical advisor to an early-stage water-utility startup, I spend my time doing this role's core loop on a weekly basis: understanding what an operator actually needs on the ground, then making sure that gets reflected in what the product team builds next.

I'm comfortable with travel, ambiguity, and a fast pace — my background includes outdoor education and a string of early-stage companies where the job was never fully defined until someone figured it out. I'd rather be on a ranch figuring out what's actually broken than in a conference room theorizing about it, and I'd bring that same get-stuff-done instinct to Halter's U.S. ranchers.

I'd welcome the chance to talk about how my geospatial background, product-translation experience, and genuine long-term interest in ranching could help Halter's U.S. expansion succeed.

Thank you for considering my application. I'd love the opportunity to talk.

Warmly,

Katrina Engelsted

BOULDER, COLORADO